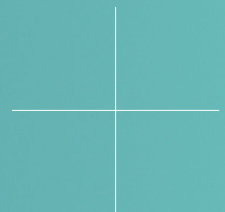




CHAPTER VII

International Cooperation

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01 Contribution to China's Foreign Affairs

President Xi Jinping witnessed the signing of cooperation agreements between CNIPA and the competent IP authority of the United Arab Emirates, and the renewal of the protocol for cooperation on agricultural and food geographical indications between China and France has been included in the list of achievements of President Xi Jinping's visit to France. CNIPA provided support in holding the International Association for the Protection of Intellectual Property (AIPPI) World Intellectual Property Conference 2024 and deeply studied the spirit of the important congratulatory letter from President Xi Jinping. Premier Li Qiang witnessed the signing of cooperation agreements between CNIPA and the competent IP authorities of New Zealand and Italy, the Memorandum of Understanding on Cooperation between CNIPA and IP Australia has been included in the list of achievements

of Premier Li Qiang's visit, and the 9th ROK-Japan-China Trilateral Summit issued the *Joint Statement on a 10 Year Vision for Trilateral IP Cooperation*. Intellectual property content was included in the *Joint Declaration of the 9th ROK-Japan-China Trilateral Summit and the XVI BRICS Summit Kazan Declaration*.

In April, Vice Premier Ding Xuexiang met with the Director of the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO) and put forward clear requirements for deepening IP cooperation between China and the United States. In September, Vice Premier Ding Xuexiang attended the opening ceremony of the Third Belt and Road Forum for International Cooperation and delivered a speech, emphasizing the important role of IP in the joint pursuit of high-quality Belt and Road cooperation.

02 Deepening the Engagement in Global IP Governance

2.1 Promotion of adjustments to international IP norms

In May, Deputy Commissioner Lu Pengqi led a delegation to attend the Diplomatic Conference on Genetic Resources and Associated Traditional Knowledge in

Switzerland to promote the successful conclusion of the *WIPO Treaty on Intellectual Property, Genetic Resources and Associated Traditional Knowledge*.



A Delegation of the Chinese Government Attending the Diplomatic Conference on Genetic Resources and Associated Traditional Knowledge in Switzerland

In July, Commissioner Shen Changyu led a delegation to attend the 65th Series of Meetings of the Assemblies of the Member States of WIPO in Switzerland, calling on the States to give better play to the role of WIPO as the main platform for international IP norm-setting,

continue to promote the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development of the UN, and continuously improve the WIPO global IP service system to meet the needs of global innovation entities.



A Delegation of the Chinese Government Attending the 65th Series of Meetings of the Assemblies of the Member States of WIPO in Switzerland

In November, Deputy Commissioner Lu Pengqi led a delegation to attend the WIPO Diplomatic Conference to Conclude and Adopt a Design Law Treaty in Saudi

Arabia, promoting the successful conclusion of the *Riyadh Design Law Treaty*.



A Delegation of the Chinese Government Attending the WIPO Diplomatic Conference to Conclude and Adopt a Design Law Treaty in Saudi Arabia

CNIPA participated in institutional meetings of WIPO, such as the Program and Budget Committee (PBC), Committee on Development and Intellectual Property

(CDIP), Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT), and Standing Committee on the Law of Trademarks, Industrial Designs and Geographical Indications (SCT).

2.1 Deepened bilateral cooperation with WIPO

Commissioner Shen Changyu and WIPO Director General Daren Tang held three meetings in March, July and September, respectively, exchanging views in

depth on issues of common interest, which led to fruitful practical cooperation at all levels.



Commissioner Shen Changyu Meeting with WIPO Director General Daren Tang

In April, Commissioner Shen Changyu met with Ms. Yolanda Huerta Casado, Vice Secretary-General of the International Union for the Protection of New Varieties of Plants (UPOV) to continuously consolidate and enhance the cooperation between the two sides.

In October, CNIPA jointly organized with WIPO the Celebration of the 30th Anniversary of China's Accession to the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT), the Thirty-First Session of the Meeting of International Authorities under the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT), the 14th Session of the PCT Working Group, and PCT Roving Seminars, among other activities.



Up: The Celebration of the 30th Anniversary of China's Accession to the Patent Cooperation Treaty (PCT)

Down: The 31st Session of the Meeting of International Authorities under the PCT and the 14th Informal Session of the MIA Quality Subgroup

03 IP Cooperation Under the “Belt and Road” Framework

In May, the 2024 Belt and Road Training Program on Intellectual Property was held and participated by 27

intellectual property officials from 25 Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) partners.



**The Belt and Road
Training Program on
Intellectual Property
2024**

In September, CNIPA held the 3rd High-Level Conference on Intellectual Property for Countries along the Belt and Road in Beijing jointly with the Publicity Department of the Communist Party of China (the National Copyright Administration of China), the People's Government of Beijing Municipality, and WIPO. More than 150 foreign representatives from nearly 70 Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) partner national and regional organizations

participated in the conference. The conference released *China's Initiative on Deepening Intellectual Property Cooperation along the Belt and Road*, resulting in 19 practical cooperation deliverables. At the sidelines of the conference, more than 20 bilateral exchange activities were carried out, and 16 cooperation agreements were signed.

In December, the 2024 Belt and Road Trademark Training Program was held, with 10 intellectual property officials from 5 Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) partner countries participating in the training.

CNIPA continuously carried out the Belt and Road Master Degree Program in Intellectual Property, with 20 students from 11 countries enrolled to pursue their studies in China.



The 3rd High-Level Conference on Intellectual Property for Countries Along the Belt and Road and the 3rd Belt and Road Round Table on Intellectual Property

04 Plurilateral Cooperation

4.1 IP5, ID5 and TM5 cooperation

In June, Commissioner Shen Changyu attended the 17th IP5 Heads of Office Meeting in Korea, promoting the adoption of the *Joint Statement of the IP5 Offices on Cooperation* by the Parties.

In November, CNIPA hosted the IP5 WG3 Meeting aimed

at guiding all parties to better implement the new vision of IP5 cooperation.

In December, CNIPA attended the annual meetings of the TM5 and ID5. The *2024 TM5 Joint Statement* and the *2024 ID5 Joint Statement* were adopted.



CNIPA Hosting the IP5 WG3 Meeting

4.2 BRICS cooperation

In May, Commissioner Shen Changyu signed a Memorandum of Understanding on Intellectual Property Cooperation with Dr. Thani bin Ahmed Al Zeyoudi, UAE Minister of State for Foreign Trade in Beijing.

In July, Commissioner Shen Changyu attended an informal meeting of BRICS Heads of Intellectual

Property Offices during the 65th Series of Meetings of the Assemblies of the Member States of WIPO.

In September, Commissioner Shen Changyu met with Mr. Woldu Yemessel Baraki, Director General of Ethiopian Intellectual Property Authority (EIPA) and Mr. Rory Voller, Commissioner of the Companies and

Intellectual Property Commission (CIPC) of South Africa respectively in Beijing, and signed cooperation documents.

In September, Deputy Commissioner Hu Wenhui visited the National Institute of Industrial Property (INPI) of Brazil. The two parties reached consensus on extending the PPH pilot project and signing an updated Memorandum of Understanding on Cooperation and a work plan.

In October, Commissioner Shen Changyu attended the First BRICS Heads of Intellectual Property Offices

Meeting held in Russia since the expansion of the BRICS IP cooperation, and all parties reached a consensus on revising the Operational Guideline Framework document. During the meeting, Commissioner Shen Changyu held a meeting with Mr. Yury Zubov, Head of the Federal Service for Intellectual Property (ROSPATENT), and signed a Memorandum of Understanding on data exchange between the two offices; and held a meeting with Mr. Grigory Ivliev, President of the Eurasian Patent Organization (EAPO), and exchanged views on IP commercialization and utilization and the enhancement of IP awareness.



Commissioner Shen Changyu Attending the 17th IP5 Heads of Office Meeting in Korea

4.3 CNIPA-JPO-KIPO cooperation

In December, Commissioner Shen Changyu hosted a series of events in Shanghai including the 24th TRIPO Heads Meeting, the 31st CNIPA-JPO Heads Meeting, the 30th CNIPA-KIPO Heads Meeting, and the 12th TRIPO User Symposium, and signed meeting minutes and an updated CNIPA-KIPO Memorandum of Understanding on IP information and data exchange.

Business cooperation with the Japan Patent Office (JPO) and the Korean Intellectual Property Office (KIPO) was comprehensively deepened, and more than 30 bilateral and trilateral cooperation projects were carried out in areas such as patent and trademark examination, personnel exchanges, and informatization.



Up: The 24th TRIPO Heads Meeting
Down: The 12th TRIPO User Symposium

05 Bilateral Cooperation

5.1 Cooperation with EPO and EUIPO

In July, Commissioner Shen Changyu held bilateral talks with Mr. João Negrão, Executive Director of the European Union Intellectual Property Office (EUIPO) in Switzerland, and signed the 2024-2025 Annual Work

Plans for the two parties to deepen cooperation in the fields of design and trademarks.

In October, Commissioner Shen Changyu hosted the

18th Heads Meeting between CNIPA and the European Patent Office (EPO) in Chengdu, and jointly signed the 2025 Annual Work Plan for the two offices with António Campinos, President of the EPO, to promote the

CNIPA-EPO PCT Pilot Project on International Searching Authority (ISA) to enter the second phase, enabling Chinese applicants designating the EPO as their ISA to pay international search fee through the CNIPA in RMB.



The 18th Heads Meeting Between CNIPA and EPO Held in Chengdu

5.2 Cooperation with European countries

In March, Deputy Commissioner Li Danlu visited the Intellectual Property Office of the Republic of Serbia, the Hungarian Intellectual Property Office (HIPO), and the Hellenic Industrial Property Organization (OBI), having in-depth discussions with all parties on the latest developments in the IP field, the revision of the Implementing Regulations of the Patent Law, best practices in IP public services, and bilateral cooperations.

In April, Commissioner Shen Changyu met with Mr. Janusz Wojciechowski, European Commissioner for Agriculture of the European Commission in Beijing, having in-depth exchanges on the legal system and practices in the field of geographical indications to promote further improvement in the protection and management of geographical indication products.

In May, Commissioner Shen Changyu visited the French Ministry of Agriculture and Food Sovereignty and the National Institute of Origin and Quality (INAO) and renewed the *Protocol for Cooperation on Agricultural and Food Geographical Indications between China and France*.

In July, Commissioner Shen Changyu signed a Memorandum of Understanding on geographical indications with Massimo Ambrosetti, Italian Ambassador to China in Beijing.

In September, Commissioner Shen Changyu met with Mr. Vladimir Marić, Director of the Intellectual Property Office of the Republic of Serbia, and Mr. Panagiotis Kanellopoulos, the Director General of the Hellenic Industrial Property Organization (OBI) in Beijing and signed Memoranda of Understanding on cooperation respectively.

In September, the responsible official of the Patent Office of the CNIPA visited the IP offices of Denmark, the Netherlands and the United Kingdom respectively, and attended the International Conference on Intellectual Property Protection in Europe in the Czech Republic.

In November, Commissioner Shen Changyu held talks with Mr. Adam Williams, Chief Executive and Comptroller-General of the UK Intellectual Property Office, and signed the 2025 Work Plan for the two offices in Beijing.

In December, Commissioner Shen Changyu hosted the 35th China-France Mixed Committee Meeting on Intellectual Property Rights (IPR) in Beijing and jointly signed the meeting minutes with Mr. Pascal Faure, Director General of the National Institute of Industrial Property (INPI) of France.

Personnel were sent to attend the regional conference of the Eurasian Patent Office Technology Park and the preparatory work for the CNIPA-HIPO Focal Point Mechanism Pilot Project was completed.

5.3 Cooperation with neighboring and Asian countries

In September, Commissioner Shen Changyu held talks respectively with Mr. Sok Sopheak, Secretary of State of the Ministry of Commerce and Mr. Phork Sovanrith, Secretary of State of the Ministry of Industry, Science, Technology and Innovation (MISTI), Cambodia, Dr. Muhammed Zeki Durak, President of the Turkish Patent and Trademark Office, and Mr. Soso Giorgadze, Chairman of the National Intellectual Property Center of Georgia, and signed cooperation documents respectively.

In September, Deputy Commissioner Lu Pengqi attended the 15th Meeting of China-ASEAN Heads of Intellectual Property Offices in Brunei, and the Work Plan for 2024-2025 was approved in the meeting.

In September, the responsible official of the Patent Office of the CNIPA visited the Intellectual Property Corporation of Malaysia (MyIPO) and the Department of

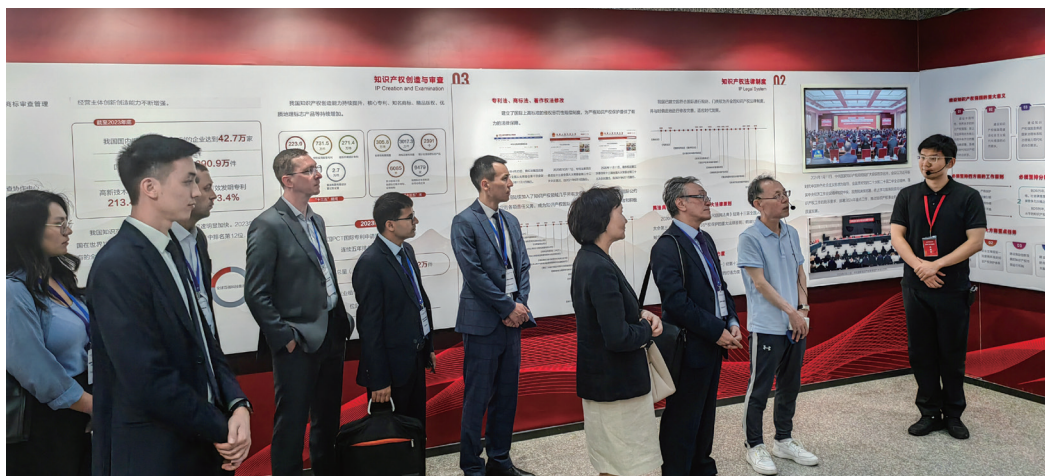
Intellectual Property under the Ministry of Commerce of Thailand to continuously deepen bilateral cooperation in the patent field.

In October, Commissioner Shen Changyu visited the National Intellectual Property Center of Georgia and reached further cooperation intentions between the two offices in the area such as talent cultivation and geographical indication.

CNIPA held activities such as the China-ASEAN online seminars on the latest developments of patent examination laws and regulations, the China-ASEAN training workshop on traditional medicine patent examination, and the IP training workshop for Central Asia, and sent experts to give lectures at the Patent Office of the Gulf Cooperation Council (GCC), as well as IP offices of Brunei, Indonesia, Turkey and other countries.

**The 15th Meeting
of China-ASEAN
Heads of Intellectual
Property Offices**





The IP Training Workshop for Central Asia

5.4 Cooperation with North America and Oceania countries

In March, Commissioner Shen Changyu held talks with Mr. Michael Schwager, Director General of IP Australia, and signed a memorandum of understanding on cooperation in Beijing.

In April, Commissioner Shen Changyu held bilateral talks with Ms. Kathi Vidal, Director of the U.S. Patent and Trademark Office (USPTO), and signed a new memorandum of understanding on cooperation in Beijing.

In October, Deputy Commissioner Lu Pengqi paid working visits to New Zealand and Australia, had in-depth exchanges of views on bilateral cooperation, IP protection and utilization, and PPH pilot projects, and signed a bilateral work plan with Australia.

CNIPA held expert exchange activities in the fields such as design, patent documentation and automation between China and the United States, and received visits of delegations from the US industries.



Heads Meeting Between CNIPA and USPTO

5.5 Cooperation with Latin American and African countries

In March, Deputy Commissioner Liao Tao visited the Cuban Industrial Property Office (OCPI), the National Service of Intellectual Rights (SENADI) of Ecuador, and the National Registry of Costa Rica, reached a consensus with all parties on deepening IP cooperation under the Belt and Road Initiative, and signed the minutes of the meeting between CNIPA and SENADI.

In April, Commissioner Shen Changyu met in Hainan with Mr. Bemanya Twebaze, Director General of the African Regional Intellectual Property Organization (ARIPO), and Mr. Denis Bohoussou, Director General of the African Intellectual Property Organization (OAPI) respectively.

In August, Deputy Commissioner Hu Wenhui visited the National Institute of Industrial Property (INPI) of Brazil, the National Institute of Industrial Property (INAPI)

of Chile, and the National Institute for the Defense of Competition and the Protection of Intellectual Property (INDECOPI) of Peru, reached consensus on extending the PPH pilot project with the INPI of Brazil, and signed the minutes of the meeting with the counterpart of Chile.

In September, Commissioner Shen Changyu met with Mr. Bemanya Twebaze, Director General of the African Regional Intellectual Property Organization (ARIPO), and jointly signed the revised PPH agreement in Beijing.

In November, the 2024 Intellectual Property Training Workshop for the African Region was held in Fuzhou, participated by 15 IP officials from 13 African national IP offices and regional organizations. Examination experts were sent to give lectures in Ecuador.



Up: Intellectual Property Training Workshop for the African Region
Down: Examination Experts From CNIPA Giving Lectures in Ecuador

06 Participation in Intergovernmental Dialogues and Negotiations

CNIPA enhanced coordination with relevant domestic departments to work on trade-related IP under the framework of the World Trade Organization (WTO), and participated in the consultation and negotiation of the *International Treaty on Pandemic Prevention, Preparedness and Response* under the framework of the World Health Organization (WHO).

CNIPA actively participated in the negotiations on the IP sections of the China-Peru, China-Honduras, China-Salvador, and China-Australia Free Trade Agreements, as well as the high-level consultations and institutional dialogues between China and Europe, China and the UK, and China and France, etc.

07 Cooperation in Business Areas

7.1 Cooperation in Patent Prosecution Highway (PPH)

CNIPA expanded and enhanced the PPH cooperation network, launched the PPH pilot programs with Bahrain, the African Regional Intellectual Property Organization

(ARIPO) and New Zealand, and renewed the PPH pilot programs with Germany, Iceland, Egypt, and Brazil. Its PPH partners have grown to 33, covering 84 countries.

7.2 The Belt-and-Road Accelerated Examination Pilot Program

The Belt-and-Road Accelerated Examination Pilot Program was implemented innovatively to provide accelerated examination for patent applications filed in China by applicants from Belt and Road Initiative (BRI) partners. This program was released as a key

cooperation deliverable of the 3rd Belt and Road High-Level Conference on Intellectual Property, and the Turkish Patent and Trademark Office became the first IP office to participate in the program.

7.3 Exchanges on patent examination business

The bilateral quality expert meeting between China and Europe and the patent expert meeting between China and Korea were successfully held. CNIPA organized exchanges among examiners with the European Patent

Office, and IP offices of the UK, Finland, Japan and Korea, covering 13 technical fields, with a total of 20 examiners from 10 examination departments participating in the exchanges.

7.4 Cooperation in GI and trademark

CNIPA solidly advanced the entry into force of the second batch of products listed in the *China-EU GI Agreements*, GI products related to Burgundy wine from France have been recognized in China, and the China-

Thailand GI “3+3” cooperation progressed steadily. *Letters of Intent on GI Protection and Cooperation* were signed with Serbia and Georgia respectively.

7.5 Cooperation in patent documentation

CNIPA participated in the formulation of international rules for patent classification and actively promoted the improvement of the patent classification system for emerging technologies in the field of cross-disciplinary integration. 10 proposals for IPC revision submitted by

CNIPA were adopted by WIPO. CNIPA independently led a project at the Committee of Experts of the IPC Union for the first time and participated in the formulation of the international standards for PCT minimum documentation.

08 Disseminating the Chinese IP Story

8.1 International publicity in the IP field

CNIPA enhanced exchanges with foreign embassies and IP attachés in China, and held a local tour of IP attachés in China in Zhejiang for the first time, with 12 IP officials from 8 countries participating in the event. Visits of officials from the embassies of Poland, Spain, Cuba and other countries in China were received, and personnel were sent to attend the activities held by the embassies of the UK, France and Italy in China.

CNIPA continued to grant the Award for Chinese Outstanding Patented Invention jointly with WIPO. At the WIPO Global Awards, 4 Chinese companies were shortlisted in the top 25 finalists and 1 Chinese company won the Award.



The Local Tour of IP Attachés in China Held in Zhejiang for the First Time

8.2 Outreach to foreign and domestic enterprises

CNIPA's leaders met with representatives from the companies such as AstraZeneca, Abbvie and Garrett, received visits of representatives from the institutions such as the International Trademark Association, the American Chamber of Commerce in China, the Licensing Executives Society International (LESI), and the Pharmaceutical Research and Manufacturers of America (PhRMA), and provided assistance to the resolution of patent and trademark claims of foreign enterprises.

CNIPA held activities such as the webinars on the PCT system, the China-Europe roving seminar in the field of patents and trademarks, and the China-Eurasia seminar on intellectual property. Chinese enterprises were organized to participate in user seminars under the frameworks of WIPO, IP5, and TRIPO to better understand the latest development of overseas intellectual property.